



Intel Wi-Fi technology for handhelds

allows users to transmit videos and images from a PC to a high-definition device like a television by using wireless media.

Equipping all the Intel devices with this Wi-Fi technology will make it easier to view HD content that users have stored on mobile devices. The Wi-Fi will enable more efficient communication between handheld gadgets and TV sets. It is all set to change the way people view content and utilise their mobile devices.

Print display on almost any surface

USA-based Ntera has developed a nanotechnology to mass-produce electronic displays on a wide range of paper, packaging, ticket and greeting card products. The technology allows colour displays to be 'printable' on almost any traditional printable product at low cost and with minimal power requirements.

To construct these displays, called NanoChromics, an array is made of electrodes created from a metal-oxide semiconductor. The electrodes are mounted on a flexible film, to which

electrochromic molecules are attached. A charge applied through the semi-conducting particles causes the molecules at the surface to be charged and thus change colour.

The displays can produce images with a resolution equivalent to that of a conventional inkjet printer. These can be changed electronically, like an LCD, instead of being static images. Also, they can be viewed from virtually any angle and under a wide range of lighting conditions.

HP to replace glass displays with plastic

In an effort to figure out how to reduce the production cost of its laptops and other devices, HP has realised that plastic substrates and their manufacturing process are cheaper than the glass substrates currently being used to make laptop display or monitor.

Researchers at HP are working on a process that uses super-thin plastic 50 microns thick (half the thickness of a piece of paper). Because plastic is flexible, it can be put on spools and put into a machine that etches resistors—the electronics that helps to render an image onto a display—in a process that resembles the way a newspaper is printed.

Manufacturing this flexible material for display on a roll is much faster and therefore cheaper than the current batch process, through which giant pieces of glass are moved by mammoth

robotic arms in factories the size of some small cities.

Push e-mail service for low-end phones

Fifth C, a mobile applications company based in Bengaluru, has unveiled the first-of-its-kind push e-mail mobile application that enables ordinary phones to send and receive mails without having to pay for GPRS.

BlacMail allows users to access their mails on their cellphones anywhere in India and through any GSM network. Unlike other pull e-mail applications available in the market, BlacMail pushes mails to your phone as soon as they land in your e-mail inbox. It wakes up your phone only when an unread e-mail from your Internet account is pushed to it, while other services of the similar kind pull an e-mail to your phone by frequently checking your Internet mail accounts for unread mails, unnecessarily draining the battery life of your phone.

The free trial version of BlacMail is available at www.blacmail.in.

Contactless payment via microSD card

Visa has partnered with DeviceFidelity, a mobile payment technology firm, to come up with a special iPhone case that enables a cellphone to transform into a credit card. Named as 'In2Pay,' the case is embedded with a removable microSD card that stores and transmits credit card information.

The case is based on Visa's PayWave contactless payment system and meant for iPhone 3G and iPhone 3GS. To pay with your phone, you activate a password-protected iPhone applica-

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Corporate Office : B - II/8, Sector - 10, Noida, U.P. (India) Tel. : + 91 - 120 - 4518 900 (20 Lines)

info@sparshsecuritech.com | www.sparshsecuritech.com

